

Lesson Planner — How to Use Guide

For Cameroonian secondary school teachers following the MINESEC Competence-Based Approach (CBA).

Website: <https://oc-lesson-planner.netlify.app>

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1. Getting Started

Lesson Planner is an **offline-first web app**. It works on any phone, tablet or computer with a modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Safari, Firefox). You do not need to install anything or create an account.

Opening the app

1. Open your browser and go to: <https://oc-lesson-planner.netlify.app>
2. The first time, you will see the "Welcome to Lesson Planner" screen.
3. Tap **Get Started** to begin the one-time setup (see Section 2).

Installing it as an app (recommended)

Add it to your home screen so it opens like a normal app and works with no internet connection:

- **Android / Chrome:** tap the : menu → **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.
- **iPhone / Safari:** tap the **Share** icon → **Add to Home Screen**.
- **Desktop Chrome/Edge:** click the install icon in the address bar (a monitor with a ↓ arrow).

Note: Once installed, the app stores everything on your device. AI generation is the only feature that needs internet.

2. Onboarding — Setting Up Your Profile

The first time you open the app you set up your profile. This takes less than a minute and happens only once.

1. On the welcome screen, tap **Get Started**.
2. On the "Your Profile" screen, fill in:
 - **Your name** — e.g. Ndukong Emmanuel Ngeh
 - **School** — e.g. Government High School Dumbu
 - **Region** — e.g. North-West
3. Tap **Continue**.
4. You will see the "Subjects" screen showing that **12 national syllabuses are already pre-loaded** (Biology, Human Biology, Chemistry, Citizenship Education, Computer Science, Economics, Geography, Geology, History, Literature in English, Mathematics and Physics — all Form 1 to Form 5).
5. Tap **Start Planning**. You are now on the Dashboard.

Note: You can change your name, school or region later in Settings → Profile. These appear on your exported lesson plans.

3. Getting a Free AI Key

AI generation is **optional**. You can write every lesson by hand if you prefer. To let the app draft lessons for you, you need a free key from one of the two supported providers. The free tiers are more than enough for a single teacher.

Option A — Gemini (Google AI Studio) (*recommended*)

1. Go to <https://aistudio.google.com/apikey>
2. Sign in with any Google account.

3. Click **Create API key** (accept the terms).
4. Copy the key — it looks like Alza...

Option B — Groq

1. Go to <https://console.groq.com/keys>
2. Create a free account or sign in.
3. Click **Create API Key**.
4. Copy the key — it looks like gsk_...

Note: Your API key is stored **only on your own device** and is sent only to the AI provider when you generate. Keep it private, like a password.

4. Configuring Settings

Open **Settings** from the left menu (on a phone, open the menu first). Settings are grouped into cards.

Profile

Update your name, school and region, then tap **Save Profile**.

AI Configuration

Setting	What to do
Gemini API key	Paste your Gemini key (from Section 3, Option A).
Groq API key	Paste your Groq key (from Section 3, Option B).
Preferred provider	Choose Gemini or Groq (the one whose key you entered).
Model	Tap the  refresh button to load the current list of free-tier models, then pick one.
Auto-generate	Optional: tick this to auto-draft a full lesson whenever you open a new week.

1. Paste your API key(s).
2. Choose your **Preferred provider**.

3. Tap the  **refresh** button next to **Model** — the app fetches the current list of available free-tier models from the provider using your key, so you always see up-to-date choices.
4. Pick a model from the dropdown.
5. Tap **Save AI Settings**.
6. Tap **Test Connection** to confirm your key works. A green "Connection successful" message means you are ready.

Note: Models change over time. If generation ever fails with a model error, return here and tap  **refresh** to load the latest available models.

Calendar

School weeks run **Monday to Friday** across a 36-week year. Set these once per school year:

Setting	What to do
Academic year	Pick from the dropdown, e.g. 2025/2026.
Year start date	The first Monday of the school year.
Christmas / New Year	Set the start and end dates of the 2-week end-of-year break.
Easter	Set the start and end dates of the 2-week Easter break.

1. Tap **Save Calendar**.

Note: Holiday dates change every year in Cameroon — update these each new school year. The progression grid updates automatically when you save.

Display

- **Theme** — Light, Dark, or System (follows your device).
- **Font size** — drag the slider to make text bigger or smaller.

Data (backup)

- **Export All Data (Backup)** — downloads a backup file. Keep this safe!
- **Import Backup** — restores your data from a backup file.
- **Clear All Data** — erases everything and resets the app. Use with care.

Note: Back up regularly (e.g. once a month) so you never lose your lesson plans.

5. Choosing Your Subject and Class Level

1. Use the **Subject** dropdown in the left sidebar to pick your subject.
2. Use the **Class Level** dropdown to pick Form 1, 2, 3, 4 or 5.

Only the class levels that exist for that subject are shown. For example, Human Biology and Geology only have Forms 4–5, and Economics only has Forms 3–5.

6. The Progression Grid

Open **Progression** from the menu. This is your map for the whole school year — a 36-week plan for your subject and class.

- **Week** — the week of the school year (1–36).
 - **Seq** — the sequence number (1–6). Each sequence ends with an evaluation.
 - **Module / Chapter / Lesson** — the topic to teach that week.
 - **Dur** — how many periods that lesson needs.
 - Holiday weeks show a party icon 🎉; evaluation weeks show a sword icon ⚔️.
1. Tap any week to open (or create) its lesson plan.
 2. Tap **Plan Next** to jump straight to your next unplanned week.

You can filter by term (Term 1, 2, 3) or view the whole year with **All**.

7. Creating a Lesson Plan

1. From the Progression grid or Dashboard, tap the week you want to plan (or **Plan Next**).
2. The Lesson Plan editor opens, already filled with that week's topic, module and chapter.
3. Complete each section. You can type manually, or use the AI to help (see below).

The sections

Section	What it is
Previous Knowledge	What learners should already know from earlier lessons.
Objectives	3–5 measurable goals starting "By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to..."
Introduction (5 min)	A short hook — a question, story or demonstration.
Activities	Learner-centred tasks (individual, group, practical, discussion).
Materials	Items available in your school/community (e.g. chalk, string, bottles, stones).
Lesson Notes	The full content learners copy into their exercise books.
Conclusion	Key takeaway and link to the next lesson.
Homework	1–2 practical assignments (no internet needed).
Evaluation Criteria	How you will know the objectives were met.
Cross-Cutting Competencies	Tick relevant ones: Communication, Problem-solving, Citizenship, ICT, Creativity, Cooperation.
Differentiation	How you support slower and faster learners.

- At the bottom, set the **Status** (Planned, In Progress, Completed, Partial or Skipped).

Note: Everything auto-saves as you type — there is no separate Save button for the lesson.

Using AI to generate content

- Tap **Generate Full Lesson** to have the AI draft the whole lesson from the syllabus context, then review and tap **Accept All**.
- Or tap **Generate with AI** next to any single section to fill just that one section.

The AI works best when you have set an API key (Section 3), picked a model (Section 4) and are connected to the internet. Always review AI content before teaching.

8. Following Up (Planned → Done)

Track your progress so you always know where you are in the school year.

Dashboard

- Shows **this week's lesson**, your overall completion %, and alerts if you are falling behind.

Progress Tracker

Open **Progress** from the menu. It shows:

- **Overall progress** — how many lessons you have completed.
- **Sequence breakdown** — progress within each of the 6 sequences.
- **Calendar heatmap** — a colour-coded view of all 36 weeks (green = completed, red = skipped, amber = evaluation).
- **Export Report** — downloads a text summary you can share with your HOD.

Updating a lesson's status

1. Open the lesson (tap its week in the Progression grid).
2. Scroll to **Status** and tap the current state: Planned → In Progress → Completed.
3. Add a note in **Teacher's Reflection** after teaching (what went well, what to improve).

Note: Marking lessons as Completed keeps your Dashboard and Progress Tracker accurate.

9. Exporting Lesson Plans (PDF / Word)

Single lesson

1. Open the lesson.
2. Scroll to the bottom and tap **Export PDF** or **Export Word**.

This downloads a print-ready document you can print or send to your Head of Department or inspector.

Batch export (multiple lessons)

1. Open **Export** from the menu.

2. Choose a **range**: Week, Sequence, Term, or Custom (start/end week).
 3. Tick the lessons you want (or leave unticked to export all in range).
 4. Tap **Export as PDF** or **Export as Word (.docx)**.
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10. Sharing Subject Templates

You can share a whole subject (its syllabus + progression + calendar) with a colleague, and import theirs.

1. Open **Sharing** from the menu.
2. Tap **Export {subject} Template** to download a JSON file.
3. Send that file to a colleague (WhatsApp, email, etc.).
4. A colleague imports it from the onboarding "Subjects" screen or the Sharing page via **Choose template file**.

Note: This is a handy way for a department to share a carefully-edited progression across teachers.

11. Tips & Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need internet?

No. The app and all your lessons work fully offline. Internet is only needed to install the app once and to use AI generation.

Is my data safe?

Yes. Everything is stored on your own device. There is no account and no cloud. Use **Settings** → **Export All Data (Backup)** to make your own backup.

How much does the AI cost?

Nothing, within the free tier. Gemini and Groq both give free usage that is plenty for one teacher generating a few lessons per week.

Can I use it on my phone?

Yes. It is designed to work on phones in the classroom, with no internet. Install it to your home screen for the best experience.

What if I change schools or subjects?

Just switch subject/class in the sidebar, or update your profile in Settings. Your previous data stays on your device.

What if my model stops working?

AI models change over time. Open **Settings → AI Configuration** and tap the  **refresh** button next to Model to load the latest available models, then save.

What if a new subject syllabus comes out?

You can import a subject template shared by a colleague, or the author can add new syllabuses to future versions.

Remember: holiday dates change every year — update your Calendar in Settings at the start of each school year.